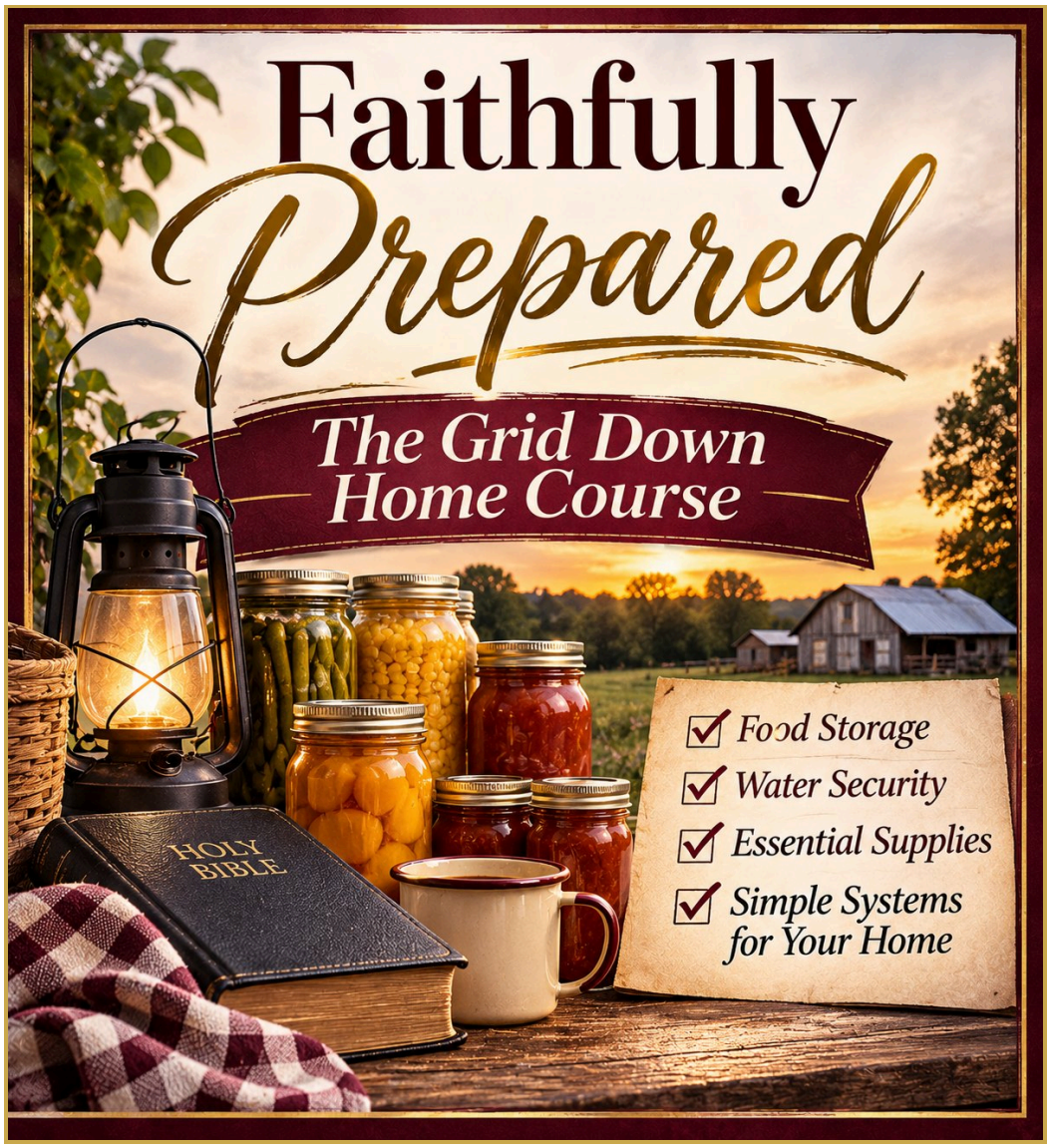


From Prayer 2 Provision

BY AMBER LALOUX

Welcome, Mama

This course walks your family from zero to ready for a power outage or grid down situation, one level at a time, on a real family budget.

A complete 13-module home preparedness course · Thank you for being here, mama.

> *"For God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind."* — 2 Timothy 1:7 (KJV)

Preparing is not living in fear. It is stewardship. Joseph stored grain in the years of plenty so his family and nations could eat in the years of famine. You are doing the same thing for your household, one jar of rice and one gallon of water at a time.

How this course works

Every module is tagged with a level so you always know what to do first, and every module ends with a short Bible study you can do on your own or with a friend.

Level	Goal	What it covers
Level 1: First Steps	Get through 72 hours	Water, light, a way to cook, a few days of food, medications, a go bag
Level 2: Two Weeks Ready	Shelter in place for 14 days	Deeper pantry, water treatment, warmth, sanitation, pets, backup power
Level 3: Long Haul	Self reliance for months	Long term food storage, pressure canning, seeds and gardening, barter

My advice: finish Level 1 before you buy anything for Level 2. A family with 3 days of water beats a family with a 50 lb bag of rice and nothing to drink.

Your printables: every lesson has a printable linked inside it, and you will find them all together in the **Your Printables Library** section near the end of the course.

A note on safety

Some of the skills here use open flame, chemicals, and stored fuel. Read every safety box. Keep a working smoke detector and a battery powered carbon monoxide detector in your home, and a fire extinguisher where you cook. Prices listed are what I have found in my area in fall 2026 and will vary where you live.

Before You Begin: Covering Your Home in Prayer (All Levels, Start Today)

Before we buy a single gallon of water, we cover our homes, our husbands, and our children in prayer. Our preparation is wise, but our protection comes from the Lord.

> *"Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it: except the LORD keep the city, the watchman waketh but in vain."* — Psalm 127:1 (KJV)

First things first: not by bread alone

> *"It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God."* — Matthew 4:4 (KJV)

When Jesus was hungry in the wilderness, He answered the enemy with Scripture. He was quoting Deuteronomy 8:3, where Moses reminded Israel that God fed them manna so they would learn to live by His Word. Our pantry feeds our bodies, but God's Word feeds our souls. It is where we find peace when we are afraid and wisdom and discernment when the days are hard.

So the most important preparation in this whole course is not water or rice. It is a daily time in the Word. Stock your heart before you stock your shelves.

Make it daily:

- Read a chapter every morning before you check your phone or the news. Psalms and Proverbs are a beautiful place to start.
- Download your Bible app for offline reading (Module 4) and keep a paper Bible in your go bag.
- Memorize the verses in this course with your children. Scripture hidden in the heart can never be taken from them.
- Read aloud together as a family, even by lamplight.

> *"Thy word have I hid in mine heart, that I might not sin against thee."* — Psalm 119:11 (KJV)

Printable: Download your Bible study journal (one journal page for every lesson, with the verse, reflection questions, room to write, and a prayer)

God is Jehovah Jireh, our Provider

When Abraham needed a sacrifice, God provided the ram. Abraham named that place for who God had shown Himself to be.

> *"And Abraham called the name of that place Jehovahjireh: as it is said to this day, In the mount of the LORD it shall be seen."* — Genesis 22:14 (KJV)

The same God who provided then is our Provider now. We stock our shelves, but we do not put our trust in our shelves. We put our trust in Him.

We do our part, and God does His

Nehemiah's people prayed **and** stood guard. Both mattered.

> *"Nevertheless we made our prayer unto our God, and set a watch against them day and night."* — Nehemiah 4:9 (KJV)
> *"The horse is prepared against the day of battle: but safety is of the LORD."* — Proverbs 21:31 (KJV)

So we pray, and we prepare. We stay wise, we stay ready, and we rest in His keeping.

Why we mark our doorposts

On the night of the first Passover, God told the Israelites to mark the doorposts of their homes with the blood of the lamb. Every home marked by the blood was passed over.

> *"And the blood shall be to you for a token upon the houses where ye are: and when I see the blood, I will pass over you, and the plague shall not be upon you to destroy you, when I smite the land of Egypt."* — Exodus 12:13 (KJV)

Today we are covered by the blood of Jesus, the Lamb of God. God also told His people to keep His Word before their eyes, right on their homes.

"And thou shalt write them upon the posts of thy house, and on thy gates." —
Deuteronomy 6:9 (KJV)

When we anoint our doorposts and write Scripture over them, we declare who our home belongs to. The oil and the ink have no power of their own. They are an outward sign of our faith in the One who does.

How to anoint your home

You need: a small dish or bottle of olive oil, your Bible, and a quiet time when you can walk through your home.

1. **Pray over the oil.** Ask the Lord to set it apart as a symbol of His Holy Spirit and His covering.
2. **Start at your front door.** Dip your finger in the oil and touch the top and both sides of the door frame. Many women trace a small cross. Pray the doorpost prayer below.
3. **Walk through every room.** Touch each doorframe and window frame and pray for what happens in that room: rest in the bedrooms, peace at the table, health in the bathroom, provision in the kitchen.
4. **Pray over your pantry and supplies.** Thank God for His provision and ask Him to multiply it and make you a blessing to others.
5. **Finish at the back door,** praying over everyone's going out and coming in.

Practical tip: a tiny dab is enough. Oil can stain fabric and some wood finishes, so touch the frame, not the curtains.

How to anoint your family

"Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord." — James 5:14 (KJV)

- **Your children:** while they sleep or at bedtime, touch a little oil to their forehead and pray over them by name.
- **Your husband:** ask if you can pray over him. Touch his forehead or lay your hand on his shoulder and bless him as the leader and protector of your home.
- **Your extended family:** pray over them by name, even from a distance.

- **Make it a family time** if your family is open to it. Let the kids help mark the doorposts. They will never forget it.

Prayers to pray over your home

At the doorposts

Lord, I mark this door as a sign that this home belongs to You. I plead the blood of Jesus over every doorway and every window. I declare that no evil shall befall this dwelling and no plague shall come near it. Guard our going out and our coming in, from this time forth and forevermore. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Over my children

Father, I place my children in Your hands. Cover their minds with peace and their hearts with courage. When the lights go out, let them not be afraid, for You are with them. Give Your angels charge over them to keep them in all their ways. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Over my husband

Lord, I lift up my husband to You. Give him wisdom to lead our family, strength for every task, and peace that passes understanding. Protect his health, his mind, and his steps. Let him know he does not carry our family alone. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Over our provision

Jehovah Jireh, I thank You that You are my Provider. Everything on these shelves came from Your hand. Help me steward it wisely, stretch it in lean times, and share it freely when You ask me to. I trust You, not my supplies. In Jesus' name, Amen.

When fear rises

Lord, I choose to trust You. You have not given me a spirit of fear, but of power, of love, and of a sound mind. I have done my part, and I rest in Yours. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Declarations for your family

Speak these out loud together, in the light or in the dark.

- I am covered by the blood of Jesus.

- I am not afraid, because the Lord is my keeper.
- I am provided for, because my God is Jehovah Jireh.
- I am wise, I am prepared, and I am at peace.
- I am a light to my neighbors in dark times.

Doorpost Scripture cards

Write one or more of these on an index card and tape it above or beside your door. Put one over each child's bedroom door too.

"The LORD shall preserve thy going out and thy coming in from this time forth, and even for evermore." — Psalm 121:8 (KJV)

"There shall no evil befall thee, neither shall any plague come nigh thy dwelling. For he shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee in all thy ways." — Psalm 91:10–11 (KJV)

"But as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD." — Joshua 24:15 (KJV)

"No weapon that is formed against thee shall prosper." — Isaiah 54:17 (KJV)

"I will both lay me down in peace, and sleep: for thou, LORD, only makest me to dwell in safety." — Psalm 4:8 (KJV)

"But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus." — Philippians 4:19 (KJV)

Printable doorpost cards: Download and print your doorpost cards (6 cut-out cards plus an over-the-door sign)

Module 1: Start Here With $100 (Level 1)

If you only have $100, cover the basics in this order: water, food, a way to cook, light, heat, and a toilet. **Check the Dollar Tree first.** Most of this list is there for $1.25 to $1.50 an item, and that is how we stretch $100 this far.

"A prudent man foreseeth the evil, and hideth himself; but the simple pass on, and are punished." — Proverbs 22:3 (KJV)

The $100 starter list

Need	Item	Where	About
Water	2 cases of bottled water	Costco	$4 for a case of 40
Water	A bucket to catch rainwater under a downspout	Walmart, Home Depot	$6
Water	Personal water filter (LifeStraw or Sawyer style)	Walmart, Amazon	$15
Water	Regular unscented liquid chlorine bleach (to disinfect rainwater)	Dollar Tree	$1.25
Food	White rice, a few bags	Dollar Tree	$5
Food	Oats, 2 bags	Dollar Tree	$3
Food	6 cans of tuna or chicken	Dollar Tree	$7.50
Food	Electrolyte packets	Dollar Tree	$2.50
Food	Manual can opener	Dollar Tree	$1.25
Cooking and light	Tea lights, a metal muffin tin, and a lighter	Dollar Tree	$8
Cooking and light	Oil lamp and lamp oil	Walmart	$25
Heat	Coffee can heater: a metal coffee can from your pantry, a roll of toilet paper, and 2 bottles of 91% isopropyl alcohol. Keep a	Walmart, Dollar Tree	$9

Need	Item	Where	About
	baking sheet nearby to smother the flame, since coffee can lids are plastic.		
Toilet and storage	Food grade 5 gallon bucket with a lid (for your rice and oats)	Walmart, Home Depot, Lowe's	$8
Toilet and storage	Heavy duty trash bags and duct tape (for the trash bag toilet in Module 10)	Dollar Tree	$3

That gets most families to about $100. **Next to add:** a TDS meter (about $8), then a tent or sleeping bag, castile soap, and more food.

Printable: Download your $100 starter list (check off each item and write what you paid)

Why this order

1. **Water first.** You can live about 3 days without water and about 3 weeks without food.
2. **Make water safe.** Stored water runs out. A rain bucket, a filter, and bleach turn rainwater into drinking water (Module 3).
3. **Food you can make with water.** Rice, oats, and canned tuna or chicken feed a family for pennies a serving. Electrolytes keep everyone hydrated, especially children and anyone who gets sick.
4. **A way to cook.** The muffin tin stove in Module 5 turns tea lights into a burner.
5. **Light.** Darkness is when falls, fires, and fear happen. An oil lamp lights a whole room, and your tea lights are the backup.
6. **Heat.** The coffee can heater works like the alcohol can heater in Module 5. Use it with fresh air and never while you sleep.
7. **A toilet.** A trash bag taped into your own toilet is the simplest toilet there is (Module 10).

Do you need a TDS meter?

A TDS meter ($4 to $8 on Amazon) is nice to have, but it does **not** tell you if water is safe to drink. It only measures dissolved minerals and salts. It cannot detect bacteria, viruses, or parasites, which are what make people sick after a disaster. Water can read "low" and still be dangerous. Buy the filter and

bleach first, then make a TDS meter your next purchase. Module 3 shows how to use all three together.

Rainwater on a budget

You can turn a trash can into a rain barrel with a $10 to $20 spigot kit, or buy a portable rain collection kit online for about $50. Two rules:

- Use a container marked food grade (look for the #2 HDPE symbol) if you might drink from it. Regular trash cans are fine for flushing, washing, and gardens.
- **Always** filter and disinfect rainwater before drinking. Roof runoff carries bird droppings and debris.

Bible study: Wise preparation

> *"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise."* — Proverbs 6:6 (KJV)

The ant does not panic and does not hoard. She simply gathers a little at a time while the season allows. God calls preparation wisdom, not fear.

Reflect:

- Where have I let fear, or putting things off, keep me from preparing?
- What is one small step I can take this week, trusting God with the rest?

Pray: *Lord, give me wisdom to prepare and peace to trust You. I know You are my Provider. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 2: Your 72 Hour Kit (Level 1)

Every person in your home needs enough to survive 3 days, packed so you can grab it and leave in 5 minutes if home is no longer safe.

> *"I will both lay me down in peace, and sleep: for thou, LORD, only makest me to dwell in safety."* — Psalm 4:8 (KJV)

Shelter in place or go?

Most outages you will ride out at home. You leave when staying is more dangerous than going: fire, flood, a gas leak, no heat in deep cold, or an official evacuation order. Decide now where you would go (a relative, your church, a friend in another town) and how you would get there.

What goes in each bag

- [ ] Water: 2 to 3 bottles per person, plus a personal filter so you can refill along the way. Keep your 3 gallons per person stored at home or in the car, since that much is too heavy to carry.
- [ ] Food: 3 days of no cook food (peanut butter, tortillas, granola bars, canned chicken, dried fruit)
- [ ] Medications: at least 7 days, in original bottles, plus a written list of doses
- [ ] First aid kit
- [ ] Flashlight or headlamp with extra batteries
- [ ] Hand crank or battery weather radio
- [ ] Phone charger and a charged power bank
- [ ] Change of clothes, warm layer, sturdy shoes, rain poncho
- [ ] Mylar blanket or sleeping bag
- [ ] Lighter and waterproof matches
- [ ] Hygiene: wipes, hand sanitizer, toothbrush, feminine products, diapers
- [ ] Copies of IDs, insurance cards, prescriptions, birth certificates (in a zip bag, plus a photo on your phone)
- [ ] Cash in small bills ($50 to $100 if you can)
- [ ] Small tent or tarp and paracord
- [ ] Manual can opener and a spoon

- [ ] Comfort item for each child (small toy, book, or treat)

Make it work for your family

1. **Use what you have.** Backpacks from last school year work great.
2. **Kids carry their own small bag** with a snack, water, a whistle, and a card with your phone number and a meeting place.
3. **Store bags by the door or in the car trunk.**
4. **Check bags twice a year.** Rotate food and water, update medications, and swap kids' clothes for the season. Spring and fall time changes are an easy reminder.

Printable: Download your go bag checklist and family emergency plan (go bag and car kit checklists, family contacts, meeting places, walking routes, and cut-out cards for your children)

A get home kit for your car

If you are ever stranded and have to walk home, your car kit gets you there. Keep a small bag in the trunk with:

- [ ] Water bottles and a personal water filter
- [ ] Snacks that will not spoil: protein bars, peanut butter crackers, trail mix
- [ ] A warm layer, hat, gloves, and a rain poncho
- [ ] Comfortable walking shoes and an extra pair of socks
- [ ] Flashlight, phone charging cord, and a charged power bank
- [ ] Mylar blanket and a small first aid kit
- [ ] Some cash in small bills
- [ ] A printed map of your routes home

Know your way home on foot

Know your area well enough to walk it if you have to.

- **Print paper maps** of the routes you would walk: work to home, home to your children's school, and home to a family member's house or your meeting place. Keep a copy in your car and your go bag.
- **Save offline maps on your phone** too (Google Maps offline areas, Module 4).

- **Walk or drive each route once with your family** so everyone knows the landmarks.
- **Pick a meeting place** in case phones are down and you get separated.

Bible study: Ready to move

> *"And thus shall ye eat it; with your loins girded, your shoes on your feet, and your staff in your hand; and ye shall eat it in haste: it is the LORD's passover."* — Exodus 12:11 (KJV)

On the night God brought Israel out of Egypt, He told them to eat with their shoes on and their staff in hand. They were ready to move the moment He said go. A packed bag is not fear. It is readiness to follow God wherever He leads.

Reflect:

- If we had to leave in 5 minutes, what would my family grab, and where would we go?
- Am I as ready to follow God's leading in my life as I am to grab a bag?

Pray: *Lord, make my family ready to move when You say go. Lead us, guard our steps, and bring us safely where You want us to be. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 3: Water (Levels 1 to 3)

Store 1 gallon per person per day for drinking and cooking, and aim for 2 weeks. For a family of 4 that is 56 gallons, plus water for pets.

> *"And the LORD shall guide thee continually, and satisfy thy soul in drought ... and thou shalt be like a watered garden, and like a spring of water, whose waters fail not."*
> — Isaiah 58:11 (KJV)

Storing water

- **Store bought bottled water** is the easiest. Keep it sealed, cool, and out of sunlight.
- **Filling your own containers?** Use food grade jugs. Clean them with a teaspoon of bleach per quart of water, rinse, then fill with tap water. Replace every 6 months.
- **Never reuse milk jugs.** Milk residue grows bacteria and the plastic breaks down.
- **Hidden water already in your home:** your water heater tank holds 30 to 50 gallons, and ice in the freezer is drinkable as it melts. Fill bathtubs before a storm for flushing and washing.

Making water safe to drink

Any water that is not sealed store water or your own treated stored water must be made safe. Do it in this order: **settle, filter, disinfect.**

1. **Settle.** Let cloudy water sit so dirt sinks. Pour the clear water off the top.
2. **Filter.** Pour it through a clean cloth or coffee filter, then through your personal water filter.
3. **Disinfect** with one of the methods below.

Method 1: Boiling (best)

Bring water to a full rolling boil for 1 minute, then let it cool. Your muffin pan stove from Module 5 can do this slowly with the lid on.

Method 2: Unscented bleach

Use regular, unscented liquid chlorine bleach. No scented, splash less, or color safe bleach.

Water	6% bleach	8.25% bleach
1 quart	2 drops	2 drops
1 gallon	8 drops	6 drops
2 gallons	16 drops (1/4 tsp)	12 drops (1/8 tsp)
4 gallons	1/3 tsp	1/4 tsp
8 gallons	2/3 tsp	1/2 tsp

Stir and wait 30 minutes. The water should smell faintly of chlorine. If it does not, repeat the dose and wait 15 more minutes. If the water is still cloudy, double the dose. Source: EPA Emergency Disinfection of Drinking Water.

Method 3: Pool shock (long term)

Liquid bleach loses strength within about a year. Dry pool shock keeps far longer, which makes it a great Level 3 item.

- **Buy the right kind:** granular **calcium hypochlorite** only, around 65% to 78%. The label must not list algaecides, clarifiers, or stabilizers.
- **Make a stock solution (this is NOT for drinking):** dissolve 1 heaping teaspoon (about 1/4 ounce) in 2 gallons of water.
- **Treat water:** add 1 part stock solution to 100 parts water. That is about 1 pint of stock for every 12.5 gallons. Wait 30 minutes.
- **How far it goes:** a 1 lb bag makes enough stock solution to treat roughly 10,000 gallons of water. That is thousands of gallons, far more than "hundreds."

Safety: pool shock is a powerful chemical that can start fires. Store it sealed, dry, and cool, away from fuel, oil, lamp oil, and other chemicals, and out of reach of children. Label your stock solution POISON, NOT FOR DRINKING, and mix it fresh.

What a TDS meter can and cannot do

A TDS meter measures dissolved solids such as minerals and salts. It is useful for checking that your filter is working on mineral heavy water. It **cannot** detect germs, and boiling or chlorine will not

remove chemicals like fuel or pesticides. If water might be contaminated with chemicals (near flooding, farms, or roads), find another source.

Printable: Download your safe water chart (tape it inside a kitchen cabinet)

Bible study: Living water

> *"But whosoever drinketh of the water that I shall give him shall never thirst; but the water that I shall give him shall be in him a well of water springing up into everlasting life."* — John 4:14 (KJV)

Jesus met a woman at a well who came every day for water. He offered her water that would satisfy her soul forever. We store water for our bodies, but only Jesus satisfies the deeper thirst of fear, worry, and loneliness.

Reflect:

- What do I run to when my soul feels dry?
- How can I drink from God's Word daily, not only in a crisis?

Pray: *Jesus, You are my living water. When my heart is dry and anxious, fill me again with Your peace. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 4: Light, Power, and Your Phone (Levels 1 and 2)

Plan for three kinds of light: flashlights for moving around, lamps for a room, and candles as a backup. Then plan how you will keep phones and medical devices running.

> *"Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path."* — Psalm 119:105 (KJV)

Oil lamps

A glass oil lamp from Walmart costs under $20 and lights a whole room.

- Burn **lamp oil** (paraffin lamp oil). It is made for indoor lamps and has less smoke and smell. Never use gasoline, camp fuel, or rubbing alcohol in a lamp.
- Trim the wick flat and keep the flame low. A tall flame makes soot.
- Fill the lamp only when it is cool and unlit.
- Set it on a stable surface away from curtains, kids, and pets.
- Buy an extra wick and an extra glass chimney.

The oil jar candle (from your pantry)

No candles left? You can make a long burning light from a jar and cooking oil.

1. Pour a layer of rice in the bottom of a small glass jar. It adds weight so the jar will not tip.
2. Add water until the jar is about three quarters full.
3. Pour about 1/2 inch of vegetable or olive oil on top. It floats on the water.
4. Make a wick from 100% cotton: cotton string, a strip of cotton t shirt, or the cotton tip of a paper stick swab (plastic sticks melt and smoke).
5. Push the wick through a small square of foil so it floats on the oil with just the tip sticking up.
6. Let the oil soak into the wick for a few minutes, then light it.

The water underneath is your safety layer. When the oil runs out, the flame goes out. Never leave any flame unattended or burning while you sleep.

Flashlights and lanterns

Keep one LED flashlight or headlamp per person. Battery lanterns are the safest light for kids' rooms. Solar garden lights from the dollar store can charge outside in the day and light a hallway or bathroom at night.

Solar chargers and power banks

A folding solar panel with USB ports charges phones, power banks, USB fans, and USB lights straight from the sun. Charge your power banks every month so they are full when you need them.

Medical devices like CPAP machines

If someone in your home depends on a CPAP machine, oxygen concentrator, or other powered device, put it at the top of your power plan.

- **A portable power station** (a large rechargeable battery with outlets) runs most CPAP machines through the night. Look for at least 250 watt hours and a "pure sine wave" AC outlet.
- **Turn off the humidifier and heated hose** during an outage. They use most of the power. Setting humidity to off can cut power use about in half (one AirSense 11 went from about 52 watts to 25 to 30 watts). Practice a night without them now. Then use your CPAP maker's DC power cord to plug straight into a 12 volt battery or power station. Skipping the AC outlet saves power.
- **Add a solar panel** (100 watts or more) to recharge the station during the day.
- **A car inverter** can run a CPAP from your car's 12V outlet. **Only with the car outside, never in a garage.** Exhaust contains carbon monoxide.
- **Call your electric company** and ask about their medical certification program. It often gets you advance notice of planned outages and protection from shutoff. It does not guarantee faster repair.
- **Ask the doctor** for a backup plan if the device cannot run.

Apps that work without internet

Set these up **now**, while you have WiFi.

- **Google Maps offline areas:** download your city and the route to your backup location.

- **A survival guide app** based on the U.S. Army Survival Manual. Search your app store for "army survival guide" and open it once to load it.
- **American Red Cross First Aid app:** first aid steps that work offline.
- **Your Bible app:** download a translation for offline reading.
- **Save PDFs** of important documents and this course to your phone.

Printable: Download your light and power plan (light checklist, medical device plan, and apps to download now)

Bible study: The light of the world

> *"Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life."* — John 8:12 (KJV)

An oil lamp pushes back the dark in one room. Jesus pushes back the darkness in every part of our lives. When the grid goes down, our homes can still be full of light, because His light lives in us.

Reflect:

- Where do I feel like I am in the dark right now?
- How can my family be a light to our neighbors in a hard week?

Pray: *Jesus, You are my light. Shine through me and through my home, so others see You when everything else goes dark. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 5: Cooking Without Power (Levels 1 and 2)

You can feed your family hot food with tea lights, a paint can, and a little planning. Low heat cooking is slow, so keep lids on and cook foods that only need water.

"She riseth also while it is yet night, and giveth meat to her household." — Proverbs 31:15 (KJV)

Safety box: cook on a heat safe surface (your stovetop, a baking sheet, or bricks), away from curtains and paper. Crack a window for fresh air. Keep a metal lid or baking sheet nearby to smother flames. Never pour water on a wax or alcohol fire. Never leave a flame alone with children.

The tea light muffin pan stove (under $10)

1. Use a **metal** muffin or cupcake pan (never silicone). Set it on your stovetop or a baking sheet.
2. Place a tea light in each cup and light them with a long lighter.
3. The candles sit low in the cups, so the flames reach your pan with room to breathe. You do not need anything between the tin and the pan.
4. Set your cast iron skillet or small pot on top. Cast iron spreads the heat best.
5. Cover the pot with a lid to trap heat.

What it does well: warming canned soup, heating water for oatmeal or soup mixes, cooking pancakes slowly, and keeping food warm. A full pan of 12 tea lights burns about 4 hours.

Watch for: if the wax pools get very hot, the whole pan can flare up. If flames grow tall, slide the skillet off and cover the muffin pan with a baking sheet.

No muffin tin? Set the tea lights on a stone counter or other heat safe surface, and stand empty, clean tuna or chicken cans around them to hold your pot above the flames. Never heat unopened cans. They can burst.

The alcohol can heater

This makes steady heat for cooking and boiling water.

You need: a new, empty quart paint can with lid (about $5 at the hardware store), 1 roll of toilet paper, and 91% isopropyl alcohol (or denatured alcohol, which burns cleaner with less soot).

1. Remove the cardboard tube and squeeze the toilet paper roll into the can.
2. Pour alcohol over the paper until it is soaked but not pooling on top.
3. Set the can on bricks or concrete. Place a grill grate or rack over it to hold your pot about an inch above the flame.
4. Light it with a long lighter. The flame is almost invisible in daylight, so treat the can as lit until you see it is out.
5. **To put it out,** set the paint can lid on top. Never blow it out.
6. **To refuel,** wait until the can is completely out and cool. Never pour alcohol into a lit or warm can. The flame can jump up the stream into the bottle.

The toilet paper lasts through many refills. Burn time per fill depends on your can size and how much alcohol you use, so **test and time yours at home** before you rely on it. Plan to refuel during a long day.

Use it outdoors or in a very well ventilated room. Any flame indoors uses oxygen and can make carbon monoxide.

Another option: the coffee can heater

Same idea as the paint can, using a can you may already have in your pantry. It gives off gentle heat to warm hands or a small room, and it can heat a pot of water.

You need: a clean, empty **metal** coffee can (not plastic or cardboard), 1 roll of toilet paper, 91% isopropyl alcohol, and a baking sheet or metal pot lid big enough to cover the can.

1. Remove the cardboard tube and squeeze the toilet paper roll into the can.
2. Pour alcohol over the paper until it is soaked but not pooling on top.
3. Set the can on bricks, concrete, or a baking sheet. **Optional:** nestle it in a larger metal pot of sand so it cannot tip over.
4. Light it with a long lighter. The flame is almost invisible in daylight, so treat the can as lit until you see it is out.
5. **To put it out,** slide the baking sheet or metal lid over the top. Never use the plastic coffee can lid, and never blow it out.

6. **To refuel,** wait until the can is completely out and cool. Never pour alcohol into a lit or warm can.

Safety: crack a window, keep children and pets back, and never leave it burning while you sleep or leave the room. Keep your battery powered carbon monoxide detector nearby.

Save fuel: the blanket cooking trick

Bring rice, beans, or soup to a boil, then turn off the heat or put out the flame. Cover tightly, then wrap the pot in thick towels or blankets (or set it in a cooler packed with towels). The trapped heat keeps cooking the food for hours. This stretches your tea lights and alcohol a long way.

Outdoor options

- **Charcoal grill or campfire:** great for foil packs. Lay potatoes, canned meat, vegetables, oil, and seasoning on foil, fold tightly, and cook 20 to 30 minutes, flipping once.
- **Camp stove** with propane or butane.

Never use a charcoal grill, propane grill, or gas generator inside your home or garage, even with the door open. Carbon monoxide has no smell and kills.

A note on foil

I limit aluminum foil in everyday cooking, especially with acidic foods like tomatoes. In an outage it earns its place: foil packs, wind screens around your stove, and covering windows (Module 12). Keep a roll and a roll of duct tape in your supplies.

Printable: Download your cooking without power card (muffin tin stove, can heaters, blanket cooking, and safety rules)

Bible study: Fed by His hand

> *"And he looked, and, behold, there was a cake baken on the coals, and a cruse of water at his head. And he did eat and drink, and laid him down again."* — 1 Kings 19:6 (KJV)

Elijah was exhausted and afraid. God did not lecture him. He gave him a simple cake baked on coals, a jar of water, and rest. When you are feeding your family by candlelight, remember that God sees you and strengthens you for the journey.

Reflect:

- Do I let God care for me when I am tired, or do I keep pushing alone?
- What simple meal or moment can I thank God for today?

Pray: *Father, when I am weary, feed me and give me rest. Thank You for every simple meal You place on my table. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 6: The Faithful Pantry (Levels 1 to 3)

Stock simple staples that need only water, then add flavor and comfort so your family will actually eat them. Store what you eat, and eat what you store.

> *"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise: Which having no guide, overseer, or ruler, Provideth her meat in the summer, and gathereth her food in the harvest."* — Proverbs 6:6–8 (KJV)

My go to staples

- **White long grain rice.** Not brown or flavored rice. Brown rice has natural oils that go rancid in months. At Sam's Club a 50 lb bag runs a little over 50 cents a pound. No membership? Walmart's 2 lb bag is about 97 cents, cheaper than Dollar Tree.
- **Dry beans** (pinto, black, navy) and **canned beans** for when you have little fuel.
- **Flour, sugar, salt, baking soda, baking powder, and yeast packets.**
- **Quick cooking oats.** They cook fast, which saves fuel.
- **Pancake mix that only needs water.**
- **Instant potato flakes.**
- **Ramen noodles.** Not the most nutritious, but kids know and love them, and familiar food matters in a hard week.
- **Peanut butter.** High protein and calories, no cooking. Peanut butter and tortillas, on homemade bread, or with bananas if you have them.
- **Raw, unfiltered honey.** See the honey note below.
- **Tea:** tea bags and instant iced tea that only needs water. Some teas, like ginger and chamomile, are soothing when someone is sick.
- **Condiments and spices:** salt, pepper, garlic powder, bouillon, hot sauce, ketchup, mustard. They turn bland rice and beans into comfort food. Stock extra salt; it also preserves food.

Budget finds at Aldi (fall 2026, my area)

Item	About	How I use it
Canned corn, canned green beans	50 cents a can	Easy vegetables, no cooking needed
Shelf stable queso dip	$2 a jar	Cheese for pizza, pasta, rice, and potatoes when there is no milk or cheese
Organic pasta sauce	$2.19 a jar	Cheaper than canning your own if you do not grow tomatoes
Salsa	$2.19 a jar	Mix with canned chicken and wrap in tortillas for a full meal
Chef's Cupboard soup mixes (creamy potato, cheddar broccoli, 3 bean chili)	about $3	About 8 servings each, water only

Shelf stable meals and proteins

- **Canned chicken, tuna, and salmon**
- **Canned beef stew**
- **Shelf stable pork carnitas.** Heat and toss in tortillas.
- **Bone broth.** Sip it, cook rice in it, or use it instead of milk in mashed potatoes.

Smart substitutes

- **No eggs? Use aquafaba.** That is the liquid in a can of **chickpeas (garbanzo beans)**. Use 3 tablespoons in place of 1 egg in baking, or 2 tablespoons for 1 egg white. Keep a few cans on hand.
- **No milk?** Use bone broth in savory dishes, or keep powdered milk.
- **No cheese?** Shelf stable queso.
- **No bread?** Make tortillas: 2 cups flour, 1/2 teaspoon salt, 3 tablespoons oil, and about 3/4 cup warm water. Knead, rest 15 minutes, roll thin, and cook in a dry skillet. No yeast needed.
- **Yeast bread:** flour, water, salt, and yeast (plus a little sugar or honey to feed the yeast). Store yeast in the freezer to keep it alive longer.

Honey note

Buy raw, unfiltered honey from one known source, ideally a local beekeeper. Skip honey labeled as a blend from several countries. Honey keeps almost forever, sweetens oatmeal and baking, and soothes coughs and sore throats. **Never give honey to a baby under 1 year old.** It can cause infant botulism.

Something sweet for the kids

Hard days go easier with a treat. I dry mini marshmallows: spread them in a single layer on a tray for several days (or in the oven on the lowest setting) until crunchy, then store them airtight. They last a very long time and cost very little. Hard candy and chocolate chips work too.

How much food?

Plan about 2,000 calories per adult per day. Start with 3 days, then build to 2 weeks, then 3 months. Write the date on every can and jar, put new items in the back, and use the oldest first.

Printable: Download your pantry inventory sheet (track what you have, when you bought it, and when to use it)

Bible study: Daily bread

"Give us this day our daily bread." — Matthew 6:11 (KJV)

God fed Israel manna one day at a time so they would learn to trust Him every morning. A full pantry is a gift, but our trust stays in the Giver, not the shelves. We stock up, and we still pray, "Give us this day."

Reflect:

- Do I trust my pantry more than I trust God?
- How can I teach my children to thank God for every meal?

Pray: *Lord, give us this day our daily bread. Thank You for every can and every grain of rice. Help me trust You, not my supplies. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 7: Storing Food So It Lasts (Levels 2 and 3)

Buying in bulk only helps if bugs, mice, moisture, and air cannot get to it. Freeze it, seal it, and store it cool, dry, and dark.

> *"There is treasure to be desired and oil in the dwelling of the wise; but a foolish man spendeth it up."* — Proverbs 21:20 (KJV)

Step 1: Freeze first

Flour, rice, oats, cornmeal, and pasta can carry tiny insect eggs from the factory. Freeze new bags for at least 3 days to kill them. Then let the sealed bag come back to room temperature **before** opening, so moisture does not form inside.

Step 2: Choose your container

Mylar bags with oxygen absorbers (best for long term)

- Fill the bag, drop in the right size oxygen absorber, squeeze out the air, and seal it with a clothes iron or hair straightener.
- Stored cool and dry, **white rice, dry beans, rolled oats, and pasta** can last 25 years or more.
- **Sugar and salt:** seal them in mylar but skip the oxygen absorber, or sugar turns into a brick. Both keep indefinitely.
- **White flour** does not last nearly as long, about 1 to 2 years. Keep it in your rotating pantry instead.
- **Never** seal brown rice, nuts, granola, or anything moist or oily in low oxygen storage. Moist, airless food can grow the germ that causes botulism.

Mason jars with a vacuum seal (no power needed)

The no power tool for this is a **brake bleeder vacuum pump**, a hand pump sold at auto parts stores for about $25 to $35. Pair it with a mason jar sealer attachment (the kind made for FoodSaver), set the lid on the jar, put the attachment over it, and pump until the lid seals. Great for rice, beans, oats, dried fruit, and dehydrated foods.

This is for **dry foods only**. Vacuum sealing is not canning and does not make wet food safe to store.

Food grade 5 gallon buckets

- Look for the #2 HDPE symbol on the bottom, or buy from a bakery or food store.
- Put mylar bags inside the bucket. The bucket stops mice; the mylar stops air and light.
- Gamma seal lids screw on and off, perfect for the bucket you use every day.
- Keep your toilet bucket a **different color** and label it. Never mix them.

Step 3: Store it right

- Cool, dry, dark, and off the floor (on a shelf or pallet).
- Label every container with what is inside and the date sealed.
- Rotate: new food to the back, oldest to the front.

Intro to pressure canning (Level 3)

Canning lets you put up meat, broth, beans, and vegetables on the shelf. It is a whole course on its own, so here are the rules that keep your family safe.

1. **Low acid foods must be pressure canned.** Meat, poultry, broth, beans, and most vegetables need a pressure canner, not a water bath. Only a pressure canner gets hot enough to kill botulism spores.
2. **High acid foods** like fruit, jams, pickles, and tomatoes with added lemon juice can use a water bath canner.
3. **Use only tested recipes** from the National Center for Home Food Preservation, the USDA Complete Guide to Home Canning, or Ball. Never guess at times or make up your own recipe.
4. **Use a real pressure canner,** not an electric pressure cooker or Instant Pot.
5. **Adjust for altitude** and use the right pressure every time.
6. **When in doubt, throw it out.** Bulging lids, leaks, spurting liquid, or a bad smell mean the jar goes in the trash, unopened and untasted.

For the best quality, use home canned food within about a year.

Printable: Download your food storage labels (cut-out labels for buckets, jars, and mylar bags, plus toilet bucket and poison labels)

Bible study: Joseph's storehouse

> *"And let them gather all the food of those good years that come, and lay up corn under the hand of Pharaoh, and let them keep food in the cities."* — Genesis 41:35 (KJV)

God gave Joseph a plan to store grain in the good years, and that wisdom saved his family and whole nations in the famine. Storing food well is not hoarding. It is stewardship that lets us feed our own and bless others.

Reflect:

- What good season am I in right now that I can use to prepare?
- Who might God want me to bless from what I store?

Pray: *Lord, give me Joseph's wisdom. Help me store well in seasons of plenty so I can provide for my family and bless others in seasons of need. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 8: Staying Warm Without Power (Levels 1 and 2)

Do not try to heat the whole house. Pick one small room, close it off, and make a warm space inside that room where everyone sleeps together.

"Again, if two lie together, then they have heat: but how can one be warm alone?" — Ecclesiastes 4:11 (KJV)

Make a warm room

1. Choose an inside room with the fewest windows. Close the doors and roll towels against the gaps.
2. Cover windows with blankets, bubble wrap, or foil taped with duct tape.
3. Put rugs, cardboard, or yoga mats on the floor. Cold floors pull heat from your body.

A tent inside the house

Set up a camping tent in your warm room. Your family's body heat stays trapped in that small space, and it can be several degrees warmer than the room. Layer sleeping bags and blankets inside, with mylar blankets under you, shiny side up.

No tent? Drape heavy blankets over your kitchen table so they reach the floor on all sides, and pile bedding underneath. Kids love it, and it feels like an adventure instead of an emergency.

Keep bodies warm

- Dress in layers: thermal underwear, then fleece or wool, then a jacket. Avoid cotton next to the skin; it holds sweat and chills you.
- Wear a hat, wool socks, and gloves, even to bed.
- Fill a sturdy water bottle with hot water, wrap it in a sock, and tuck it in the sleeping bag.
- Eat and drink something warm before bed. Your body burns food to make heat.
- Hand warmer packets are cheap and kids can hold them.

Carbon monoxide: the danger you cannot smell

Every winter, families die trying to stay warm. Carbon monoxide has no color and no smell.

- **Never** heat your home with a gas oven or stovetop, a charcoal or propane grill, or a generator, even in the garage with the door open. Generators belong at least 20 feet from the house, away from windows.
- If you buy a portable propane heater, choose one labeled **safe for indoor use**, crack a window, and never sleep with it running.
- Own a **battery powered** carbon monoxide detector. Plug in models stop when the power does.
- Headache, dizziness, nausea, or sleepiness in several people at once can mean carbon monoxide. Get everyone outside and call 911.

Watch for hypothermia

Warning signs: shivering, confusion, slurred speech, clumsiness, or unusual sleepiness. Babies may have bright red, cold skin and very low energy. Warm the person slowly with blankets and body heat, give warm sweet drinks if they are awake, and get medical help.

Protect your pipes

In freezing weather, let faucets drip and open cabinet doors under sinks. If the outage will be long, know where your main water shutoff is so you can turn off the water and drain the lines.

Keep spirits up without power

Long, dark evenings can become some of your family's favorite memories. Keep a box of no power fun stored with your supplies so you are not hunting for it in the dark:

- Board games and card games (Uno, Go Fish, a plain deck of cards)
- Puzzles
- Coloring books, crayons, and paper
- Books and Bible storybooks to read aloud
- Worship songs to sing together

Printable: Download your staying warm card (warm room setup, carbon monoxide and hypothermia warning signs, and a no power fun box checklist)

Bible study: Under His wings

> *"He shall cover thee with his feathers, and under his wings shalt thou trust: his truth shall be thy shield and buckler."* — Psalm 91:4 (KJV)

On a cold night, the safest place for a little bird is under its mother's wings. That is how God describes His care for us. When we huddle together for warmth, we can remind our children that God's covering is closer still.

Reflect:

- Where do I need to rest under God's covering instead of carrying everything myself?
- How can I comfort my children with this verse in a scary moment?

Pray: *Father, cover my family with Your feathers. Keep us warm, safe, and at peace under Your wings. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 9: Health, Medications, and First Aid (Levels 1 to 3)

Call your doctor this week about a 90 day supply of every daily medication. Then build a first aid kit you know how to use.

> *"Beloved, I wish above all things that thou mayest prosper and be in health, even as thy soul prospereth."* — 3 John 1:2 (KJV)

Medications

1. **Ask your doctor and pharmacist** for a 90 day supply. Many insurance plans cover 90 day fills, especially through mail order.
2. **Keep a written list** of every medication, dose, prescribing doctor, and pharmacy phone number in your go bag.
3. **Rotate:** use the oldest bottle first so nothing expires on the shelf.
4. **Refrigerated medicines like insulin:** ask your pharmacist how long yours stays good at room temperature, and keep a small cooler and ice packs ready.
5. **Over the counter basics:** pain and fever reducer (for adults and kids), allergy medicine, anti diarrhea medicine, oral rehydration packets, antibiotic ointment, hydrocortisone cream, and cough drops.

Multivitamins

A diet of rice, beans, oats, and canned goods fills bellies but can run short on vitamins and minerals over weeks and months. A daily multivitamin helps fill the gaps.

- Keep an adult multivitamin and a children's chewable for the kids, enough for at least 3 months.
- Check expiration dates and rotate them like your food. Store them cool, dry, and sealed; heat and humidity weaken them.
- **Lock them up.** Children's vitamins look and taste like candy, and vitamins with iron can seriously poison a young child. If a child swallows a handful, call Poison Control at 1-800-222-1222.

- If you are pregnant or nursing, keep a prenatal vitamin instead, and ask your doctor what is right for you.

Your first aid kit

- [ ] Adhesive bandages in several sizes
- [ ] Sterile gauze pads and rolled gauze
- [ ] Medical tape and elastic bandage
- [ ] Sterile saline wound wash
- [ ] Tweezers, scissors, and safety pins
- [ ] Disposable gloves
- [ ] Digital thermometer
- [ ] 70% isopropyl alcohol and alcohol pads (for tools and skin around a wound)
- [ ] Instant cold packs
- [ ] Burn gel
- [ ] A printed first aid guide

Homemade saline for cleaning wounds

Hospitals use sterile saline and saline soaked gauze. You can make a clean salt water rinse at home:

1. Mix 1 teaspoon of **non iodized** salt into 2 cups of water.
2. Boil for 15 minutes with the lid on.
3. Let it cool covered, then pour it into a clean, boiled jar. Dip gauze in it as needed.
4. **Use it within 24 hours,** then make a fresh batch.

Homemade saline is clean, but it is not sterile like the store kind, and gauze stored wet in a jar can grow germs. For your stored kit, buy sealed sterile saline and sterile gauze, and make the homemade rinse when you run out. Deep wounds, animal bites, or wounds with spreading redness, heat, or pus need a doctor.

Potassium iodide (KI) tablets

KI is for one rare situation: a nuclear power plant accident or nuclear emergency that releases **radioactive iodine**.

- It only protects the **thyroid** gland. It does not protect the rest of the body from radiation.
- **Take it only when public health or emergency officials tell you to.** Taking it early, late, or when not needed adds risk without benefit.
- People with iodine allergies or certain thyroid conditions should not take it. Doses differ for babies and children, so follow the package and official instructions.
- In a radiation emergency, the most important step is to **get inside, stay inside, and stay tuned** to official news.

Comfort care

Tea, honey, warm broth, rest, and prayer go a long way when someone has a cold or a rough night. Keep a few favorite teas on hand, like ginger for upset stomachs and chamomile for sleep.

Babies and little ones

Babies and toddlers cannot wait out a hard week the way we can. Plan for them first.

- **Formula:** keep at least 2 weeks of **ready to feed** formula. It needs no water, so it is the safest choice when you are not sure about your water. If you use powder, mix it only with bottled water or water that has been boiled and cooled. Never water down formula to make it last longer.
- **Nursing mamas:** breastfeeding needs no power or supplies. Drink extra water and eat well so your body can keep feeding your baby.
- **Bottles:** keep extra bottles and nipples. Wash them in hot, soapy, safe water, and boil them for 5 minutes when you can.
- **Baby food and toddler snacks:** pouches, jars, and the snacks your little ones already know and love. Rotate them like the rest of your pantry.
- **Diapers and wipes:** at least 2 weeks, in the next size up too. Cloth diapers make a good backup.
- **Warmth:** babies lose heat fast. Dress them in one more layer than you are wearing and keep them in your warm room (Module 8). For sleep, use a wearable blanket or sleep sack instead of loose blankets.
- **Medicine:** infant fever reducer, a dosing syringe, and a thermometer. Ask your pediatrician now for the right dose by weight, and write it on your medication list.
- **Comfort:** a pacifier, a favorite blanket or stuffed animal, and a few small toys. Familiar things calm little hearts.

Printable: Download your medication list and first aid checklist (a family medication list, first aid kit and over the counter checklists, and the saline recipe)

Bible study: The Lord who heals

> *"For I will restore health unto thee, and I will heal thee of thy wounds, saith the LORD."*
> — Jeremiah 30:17 (KJV)

Luke was a physician, and Paul told Timothy to take something for his stomach. Using medicine and first aid is not a lack of faith. We prepare with wisdom, and we trust God as our Healer.

Reflect:

- Have I prayed over my family's health as faithfully as I have prepared for it?
- Is there a health step I have been putting off that I can take this week?

Pray: *Lord, You are my Healer. Give me wisdom to care for my family's bodies and faith to trust You with what I cannot fix. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 10: Sanitation and Hygiene (Levels 1 and 2)

In a long outage, sickness from poor sanitation is a bigger danger than hunger. A simple toilet, soap, and paper goods keep your family healthy.

"Wash you, make you clean." — Isaiah 1:16 (KJV)

If the water is off but the sewer works

You can still flush. Pour 1 to 2 gallons of stored or rain water quickly into the bowl. Use your non drinking water for this. If the sewer is backed up, do not flush; use the bucket toilet.

The trash bag toilet (easiest)

You already have a seat and a bowl. All you need is heavy duty trash bags and duct tape.

1. Bail out any water left in the bowl.
2. Lay a dry towel in the bottom of the bowl to soak up the rest.
3. Line the bowl with a heavy duty trash bag and tape it around the rim with duct tape.
4. After each use, sprinkle a scoop of cat litter or sawdust on top. This keeps the smell down.
5. When the bag is about half full, untape it, tie it closed, double bag it, and store it in a lidded trash can outside until trash service returns.
6. Wash hands every time, or use hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.

Keep the bucket toilet below as your backup for when you have to leave home.

The 5 gallon bucket toilet (backup)

You need: a 5 gallon bucket with a lid, heavy duty trash bags, a bucket toilet seat or a pool noodle, and something to cover waste (cat litter, sawdust, shredded paper, or dry dirt).

1. Line the bucket with one or two heavy duty trash bags, folded over the rim.
2. For a seat, use a toilet seat made to fit a 5 gallon bucket (see Recommended Supplies). A pool noodle sliced down one side and pressed around the rim works in a pinch, but it is not very

sanitary.

3. Slide a roll of toilet paper onto the bucket handle.
4. After each use, sprinkle a scoop of cover material on top. This controls odor and flies.
5. If you can, have family members pee in a separate container. A bucket with less liquid smells much less.
6. Keep the lid on between uses.
7. When the bag is about half full, tie it closed, double bag it, and store it in a lidded trash can outside, away from any water source, until trash service returns.
8. Wash hands every time, or use hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.

Castile soap: one soap, many jobs

A bottle of liquid castile soap replaces most of your cleaning cabinet.

- **Dishes:** wash in soapy water, rinse in clean water, then dip in a sanitizing rinse of 1 tablespoon regular unscented liquid chlorine bleach per gallon of water. Air dry.
- **Laundry:** a squirt of castile soap in a bucket of water. A clean toilet plunger makes a great agitator.
- **Body and hair:** dilute a little in water. I like stirring a spoonful of raw honey into my castile soap body wash for a gentle, moisturizing wash.
- **Tip:** do not mix castile soap with vinegar. They cancel each other out and leave a greasy mess.

Paper goods and hygiene supplies

Paper plates, cups, and plastic silverware save precious water on dishes.

- [ ] Toilet paper and paper towels
- [ ] Paper plates, cups, and plastic silverware
- [ ] Disinfecting and baby wipes (for when there is no water to wash)
- [ ] Hand sanitizer (60% alcohol or more)
- [ ] Heavy duty trash bags
- [ ] Feminine products and diapers
- [ ] Toothbrushes, toothpaste, deodorant
- [ ] Cat litter or sawdust for the bucket toilet

Printable: Download your sanitation and hygiene card (trash bag and bucket toilet steps, castile soap jobs, and a hygiene supply checklist)

Bible study: God cares about the details

> *"Thou shalt have a place also without the camp, whither thou shalt go forth abroad: And thou shalt have a paddle upon thy weapon; and it shall be, when thou wilt ease thyself abroad, thou shalt dig therewith, and shalt turn back and cover that which cometh from thee."* — Deuteronomy 23:12–13 (KJV)

God gave Israel instructions for keeping the camp clean, right down to a shovel and a place outside the camp. Nothing about our daily needs is too small or too awkward for Him. Keeping our homes clean protects our families, and it honors Him.

Reflect:

- Is there a "small" area of my life I have not invited God into?
- How can I keep my home a place of health and order, even in hard times?

Pray: *Lord, thank You that You care about every detail of my home. Help me keep my family healthy and my house in order. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 11: Your Pets (Levels 1 and 2)

Your pets need the same plan you do: food, water, medicine, and a way to go with you. Stock at least 2 weeks for every animal.

"A righteous man regardeth the life of his beast." — Proverbs 12:10 (KJV)

Pet supply checklist

- ☐ Food for at least 2 weeks, in a sealed container (rotate it like your own)
- ☐ Water: about 1 ounce per pound of body weight per day. A 50 lb dog needs a little under 1/2 gallon a day.
- ☐ 90 days of medications and preventives, plus a copy of vet records and vaccines
- ☐ Leash, collar with ID tags, and microchip number written down
- ☐ Carrier or crate for each pet
- ☐ Litter, litter pan, and waste bags
- ☐ Bowls, a blanket, and a favorite toy
- ☐ A recent photo of you with your pet (to prove ownership if you are separated)

Keep them safe in an outage

- Bring pets into your warm room. Small pets and older animals chill fast.
- Keep pets away from candles, the tea light stove, the alcohol can heater, and lamp oil. A wagging tail can knock over a flame.
- Keep pool shock, bleach, and alcohol locked away.
- Sharing food? Never give pets chocolate, onions, garlic, grapes, raisins, or peanut butter sweetened with **xylitol**. Xylitol is deadly to dogs, so check your peanut butter label.

If you have to leave

Many emergency shelters do not accept pets. Decide now which friend, family member, pet friendly hotel, or boarding place would take your animals, and keep their info in your go bag.

Printable: Download your pet emergency plan (a card for each pet with a photo spot, plus the pet supply checklist)

Bible study: He feeds the birds

> *"Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?"* — Matthew 6:26 (KJV)

God made the animals, saved them through Noah, and feeds every bird of the air. Caring for our pets is part of stewarding what God has entrusted to us. And if He cares for them, how much more does He care for you.

Reflect:

- What worry can I lay down today, knowing God feeds even the birds?
- How can I teach my children to care for God's creatures?

Pray: *Father, thank You for the animals You have entrusted to my family. Help me care for them well, and help me trust You as You care for me. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 12: Wisdom, Discretion, Cash, Fuel, Barter, and Fire (Levels 2 and 3)

Be quietly prepared and openly generous. Do not advertise what you have, and set aside some extra so you can bless others on your terms.

"Be ye therefore wise as serpents, and harmless as doves." — Matthew 10:16 (KJV)

Keep your supplies private

In a long, widespread crisis, word travels fast, and hungry, frightened people may come knocking.

- **Do not post your pantry** on social media, now or later.
- **Teach your kids** that our food storage is a family matter, not something to talk about at school or with friends.
- **Cover your windows at night.** A glowing lamp in a dark neighborhood tells everyone you have light, and maybe food. Blankets, cardboard, or foil with duct tape work.
- **Cook with lids on** and indoors when you can. Food smells travel.
- **If someone asks how you are doing,** a kind, simple "We're getting by, thank you" is enough. You do not owe anyone an inventory.

Prepare to bless

"He that hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto the LORD; and that which he hath given will he pay him again." — Proverbs 19:17 (KJV)

Set aside a "blessing shelf" of extra rice, beans, and canned goods to give through your church or to a neighbor in need. Giving through your church or a trusted leader protects your family's privacy and still meets real needs.

When sharing is hard

"And the barrel of meal wasted not, neither did the cruse of oil fail, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by Elijah." — 1 Kings 17:16 (KJV)

The widow of Zarephath had one last handful of flour and a little oil. She fed God's prophet first, and God made her flour and oil last through the whole famine. There may come a day when helping someone means taking food from your own family's plate. Ask God for the courage and strength to help when it is hard. He is your Provider, and He will make a way.

Pray for our nation and our neighbors

> *"I exhort therefore, that, first of all, supplications, prayers, intercessions, and giving of thanks, be made for all men; For kings, and for all that are in authority; that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and honesty."* — 1 Timothy 2:1–2 (KJV)

Pray for our country and its leaders. Pray for your neighbors by name. Pray that in hard times, God's people would be the ones who bring calm, food, and hope to their streets.

Barter items

When stores are closed, everyday items become valuable to trade.

- Small bottles of alcohol (brandy, whiskey, vodka)
- Coffee, tea, sugar, and salt
- Batteries, lighters, and matches
- Soap, toilet paper, and feminine products
- Seeds
- **Skills:** sewing, canning, first aid, baking bread, fixing things

Also great for trading: coffee, toilet paper, toothpaste, and any little thing you have in abundance. When something you use is on sale, buy an extra. The small, everyday things are what people miss most.

A note on alcohol as medicine: most liquor (80 proof, 40% alcohol) is too weak to disinfect. Only very high proof spirits (120 proof or higher) or 70% to 91% rubbing alcohol work for cleaning tools and skin. Clean wounds themselves with clean water or saline. And never give alcohol to warm someone up; it actually makes the body lose heat faster.

Keep cash on hand

When the power is out, card readers and ATMs stop working. Do not keep everything in the bank.

- Keep some cash at home in small bills ($1, $5, $10, $20), in a safe, hidden place.
- Put a little in your go bag and your car kit too.
- Build it slowly. Tuck away $5 or $20 whenever you can.

Keep your gas tank full

Gas pumps need power too, so when the grid goes down, so do the gas stations.

- **Top off your tank every time you drive,** and never let it drop below half. Running low is also hard on your fuel pump.
- **Fill any approved gas cans you have.** Store them outside your living space, in a shed or detached garage, away from heat and children.
- **Add fuel stabilizer** to stored gas and use it up within several months, then refill.
- **Never store gasoline inside your home.**

Fire starters from your laundry room

1. Save dryer lint (cotton lint works best; synthetic lint can melt and smell) and empty toilet paper tubes.
2. Stuff lint firmly into each tube.
3. Cut the tubes into halves or thirds.
4. **Optional upgrade:** dip each piece in melted candle wax. It burns longer and keeps them waterproof.
5. Store them in a zip bag or coffee can.

Another cheap starter: cotton balls rubbed with petroleum jelly, packed into an old pill bottle. Each one burns for a few minutes.

Ways to make fire

Keep several: lighters, waterproof matches, strike anywhere matches in a waterproof container, and a ferro rod (fire steel) that works even when wet. Store them in more than one place.

Printable: Download your cash, fuel, barter, and prayer plan (cash and fuel trackers, a barter shelf checklist, and a prayer list for your neighbors)

Bible study: Wisdom and discernment

> *"If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him."* — James 1:5 (KJV)

In a crisis, we will face choices we cannot plan for: who to trust, when to share, when to stay quiet, when to leave. God promises wisdom to anyone who asks, and He never scolds us for asking. Discernment grows as we stay in His Word and listen for His voice.

Reflect:

- What decision do I need God's wisdom for right now?
- How can I tell the difference between fear talking and the Holy Spirit leading?

Pray: *Lord, I ask You for wisdom and discernment. Show me who to trust, when to give, and when to stay quiet. Lead my family by Your Spirit. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Module 13: Growing Your Own Food (Level 3)

Buy **heirloom** seeds (also called **open pollinated** or non hybrid). Their seeds grow the same plant next year, so you can save seeds and replant forever. Start a small garden this coming season so you learn while it is low stakes.

> *"While the earth remaineth, seedtime and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night shall not cease."* — Genesis 8:22 (KJV)

Heirloom vs hybrid

Seed type	Label says	Save the seeds?
Heirloom / open pollinated	"Heirloom," "OP," or "open pollinated"	Yes. Plants grow true to the parent.
Hybrid	"F1" or "hybrid"	No. Saved seeds grow unpredictable plants or poor crops.

Easiest crops for beginners and seed saving

- **Beans and peas:** let some pods dry on the plant, then shell and store.
- **Tomatoes:** scoop seeds from a ripe tomato, let them sit in a little water for a few days, rinse, and dry.
- **Lettuce and leafy greens:** fast to harvest, easy to grow in containers.
- **Potatoes:** plant pieces of a sprouted potato. Huge calories from a small space.
- **Herbs:** basil, parsley, and chives make plain food taste good.

Squash, pumpkins, and corn cross pollinate easily, so saved seeds may surprise you. Start with the list above.

Storing seeds

- Keep seed packets in a sealed jar in a cool, dark, dry place (the refrigerator works well).

- Add a packet of silica gel or a spoonful of dry rice wrapped in a tissue to absorb moisture.
- Most seeds stay good for 2 to 5 years. Plant and replace your stock regularly.

Start small this spring

- A few 5 gallon buckets or grow bags on a sunny porch can grow tomatoes, potatoes, and herbs.
- Look up your area's last frost date with your state's extension service, and plant after it.
- Your first garden will teach you more than any book. Grow it now, while the grocery store is still open.

Printable: Download your seed saving log (track your seeds, plus a first garden checklist)

Bible study: Seedtime and harvest

> *"And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not."*
> — Galatians 6:9 (KJV)

Every garden takes patience: planting, watering, and waiting. Faith works the same way. What we plant today, in our soil and in our children's hearts, will bear fruit in God's timing.

Reflect:

- What have I been planting that I am tired of waiting on?
- What seeds of faith can I plant in my children this season?

Pray: *Lord, help me not grow weary in doing good. Bless the work of my hands, in my garden and in my home, and bring the harvest in Your time. In Jesus' name, Amen.*

Your Printables Library

Every printable in this course, all in one place. Print them all at once, or one at a time as you work through each lesson.

- **Before You Begin:** Doorpost Scripture Cards
- **Before You Begin:** Bible Study Journal
- **Module 1:** $100 Starter List
- **Module 2:** Go Bag and Family Emergency Plan
- **Module 3:** Safe Water Chart
- **Module 4:** Light and Power Plan
- **Module 5:** Cooking Without Power
- **Module 6:** Pantry Inventory
- **Module 7:** Food Storage Labels
- **Module 8:** Staying Warm
- **Module 9:** Medications and First Aid
- **Module 10:** Sanitation and Hygiene
- **Module 11:** Pet Emergency Plan
- **Module 12:** Cash, Fuel, Barter, and Prayer
- **Module 13:** Seed Saving Log
- **Master Checklists:** Levels 1, 2, and 3

Amber's Recommended Supplies

These are the affordable items I recommend throughout the course, in the order I would buy them.

Try the Dollar Tree first. Many of these items cost less there. Use these links when you need something delivered to your home.

As an Amazon Associate I earn from qualifying purchases. It costs you nothing extra and helps support this ministry.

Level 1 essentials

Item	Why I like it	Link
LifeStraw Personal Water Filter	Cheapest way to drink from rain or creek water (Module 3)	Shop on Amazon
Sawyer Squeeze Water Filter	Filters large amounts, fits standard bottles (Module 3)	Shop on Amazon
Lamplight Farmhouse Oil Lamp	Bright, simple, lasts for years (Module 4)	Shop on Amazon
Lamplight Ultra Pure Lamp Oil	Clean burning paraffin oil made for indoor lamps (Module 4)	Shop on Amazon
Unscented tea lights, 100 pack	Fuel for the muffin pan stove (Module 5)	Shop on Amazon
Metal 12 cup muffin pan	Your tea light stove base (Module 5)	Shop on Amazon
Manual can opener	The tool most families forget (Module 2)	Shop on Amazon
UCO Stormproof Matches	Light even when wet or windy	Shop on Amazon
Emergency mylar blankets, multipack	Hold in body heat for pennies each (Module 8)	Shop on Amazon

Item	Why I like it	Link
Kidde battery carbon monoxide detector	Works when the power is out (Module 8)	Shop on Amazon
Basic first aid kit	A ready start you can add to (Module 9)	Shop on Amazon

Level 2 additions

Item	Why I like it	Link
Hand crank weather radio with USB charger	News, flashlight, and phone charging with no power (Module 2)	Shop on Amazon
Folding solar panel charger with USB	Charges phones, power banks, and USB fans (Module 4)	Shop on Amazon
Rain barrel spigot kit	Turns a trash can into a rain barrel (Module 1)	Shop on Amazon
Luggable Loo toilet seat for 5 gallon bucket	A sturdier seat than a pool noodle (Module 10)	Shop on Amazon
Dr. Bronner's Pure Castile Soap	One soap for dishes, laundry, and bathing (Module 10)	Shop on Amazon
TDS meter	Checks your filter on mineral heavy water (Module 3)	Shop on Amazon
Indoor camping tent	Traps body heat in your warm room (Module 8)	Shop on Amazon
Hand warmer packets, bulk	Cheap warmth kids can hold (Module 8)	Shop on Amazon

Level 3 long haul

Item	Why I like it	Link
Mylar bags with oxygen absorbers kit	Stores rice and beans for 25+ years (Module 7)	Shop on Amazon

Item	Why I like it	Link
Gamma seal lids for 5 gallon buckets	Easy open lid for your everyday bucket (Module 7)	Shop on Amazon
Hand vacuum pump (brake bleeder)	Seals mason jars with no power (Module 7)	Shop on Amazon
FoodSaver wide and regular mouth jar sealer	Pairs with the hand pump (Module 7)	Shop on Amazon
Presto pressure canner	For meat, broth, beans, and vegetables (Module 7)	Shop on Amazon
Nesco smart canner	The one I personally use and love. It is not USDA tested for low acid foods, so for meat, broth, and beans follow the tested stovetop method in Module 7	Shop on Amazon
Heirloom vegetable seed kit	Seeds you can save and replant (Module 13)	Shop on Amazon
Ferro rod fire starter	Makes sparks even when wet (Module 12)	Shop on Amazon
iOSAT potassium iodide tablets	FDA approved; take only when officials say (Module 9)	Shop on Amazon

Always check the label before you buy pool shock: it must say **calcium hypochlorite** with no algaecides, clarifiers, or stabilizers. I recommend buying it at a pool supply store where you can read the label first.

Your Master Checklists

Print these, tape them inside a cabinet door, and check items off as you go. Finish one level before starting the next.

Printable: Download your master checklists (Levels 1, 2, and 3 on two pages)

Start every level the same way: anoint your home, put up your doorpost cards, and pray over your family.

Level 1: First Steps (72 hours)

- [ ] A daily time in God's Word, and a paper Bible in your go bag
- [ ] 3 gallons of water per person, plus water for pets
- [ ] Unscented bleach and a personal water filter
- [ ] Oil lamp, lamp oil, and a flashlight per person
- [ ] Tea lights and a metal muffin pan
- [ ] 3 days of food that needs little or no cooking, plus formula, baby food, and diapers if you have little ones
- [ ] Manual can opener
- [ ] Lighters and waterproof matches
- [ ] Mylar blankets and warm bedding
- [ ] Heavy duty trash bags, duct tape, and cat litter for the toilet
- [ ] 7 days of medications and a written medication list
- [ ] First aid kit
- [ ] Go bag for each person
- [ ] Get home kit in the car
- [ ] Printed walking maps: work to home, home to school, home to family
- [ ] Gas tank kept at least half full
- [ ] Battery powered carbon monoxide detector
- [ ] Offline maps and first aid app downloaded
- [ ] Board games, cards, and books

Level 2: Two Weeks Ready

- [ ] 14 gallons of water per person
- [ ] 2 weeks of pantry staples and shelf stable meals
- [ ] Rain collection barrel
- [ ] Alcohol can heater, tested and timed at home
- [ ] Indoor tent or table fort supplies, sleeping bags
- [ ] Castile soap, paper goods, and hygiene supplies
- [ ] 2 weeks of pet food and water, and 90 days of pet medications
- [ ] Power bank, solar charger, and a plan for any medical device
- [ ] 90 day supply of daily medications and 3 months of multivitamins
- [ ] Cash in small bills
- [ ] Gas cans filled and stored safely outside the house
- [ ] Window coverings and duct tape

Level 3: Long Haul

- [ ] Pool shock (calcium hypochlorite) stored safely
- [ ] 3 months or more of food in mylar and food grade buckets
- [ ] Brake bleeder pump and jar sealer for dry goods
- [ ] Pressure canner and a tested recipe book
- [ ] Heirloom seeds and a first garden
- [ ] Barter items and a blessing shelf
- [ ] Fire starters and a ferro rod
- [ ] Portable power station with a solar panel

A closing prayer

Father, I thank You that You are my provider and my peace. Give me wisdom to prepare and courage to keep going one step at a time. Help me steward what You have given me, protect my home and my children, and make me a blessing to my neighbors in their time of need. Let my trust be in You and not in my shelves. In Jesus' name, Amen.

"But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus."
— Philippians 4:19 (KJV)

Sources

- EPA: Emergency Disinfection of Drinking Water
- National Center for Home Food Preservation